

Giving and Receiving Feedback

Feedback that grows people, not wounds them

4 psychology approaches · tips & advice — by EvaTalk

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BEFORE YOU BEGIN

Feedback that grows people, not wounds them

Feedback is a gift... when it's well given and well received. Done badly, it wounds, hardens, or discourages.

This guide helps you understand what feedback stirs up, deliver useful feedback, and take criticism without falling apart.

Your intention

Feedback to give, or hard criticism to receive: _____

The 4 approaches

This guide works your topic through 4 complementary psychology lenses. Read, do the exercises, fill the workbook — at your own pace.

Psychodynamic — understand the root.

CBT — ease the negative thoughts.

Humanistic — reconcile with yourself.

Systemic — act on your environment.

What feedback stirs up

As the giver, giving feedback can wake a fear of conflict. As the receiver, criticism can wake a fear of rejection or judgment, depending on your history with criticism.

Seeing it helps you not confuse a professional note with a personal attack.

Example

Any criticism took Sami back to a never-pleased parent. Understanding it let him receive feedback better.

My relationship to criticism

How do you react to criticism? What does it take you back to?

Giving costs me / receiving costs me

What's harder for you: giving feedback or receiving it? Why?

→ *A professional note isn't a personal attack.*

The thoughts that interfere

'If I say that, they'll resent me' (giver), 'criticism = I'm useless' (receiver): all-or-nothing thinking turns a detail to improve into a condemnation.

Softening them makes feedback constructive on both sides.

Example

Sure criticism meant 'it's all a failure', Nia learned to isolate the precise point to improve. It changed everything.

Feedback journal

Note: the interfering thought · a fairer, more precise version.

Reframe the criticism

Turn 'I'm criticized = I'm useless' into 'here's THE precise point to improve'.

→ *A point to improve doesn't erase everything else.*

Feedback serving the relationship

Good feedback aims at growth, not judgment. As the giver, a caring intention changes everything; as the receiver, hearing the intention helps you sort what's useful.

Separating the person from the act protects the relationship.

Example

By framing her note as 'I want to help you nail this', Léa turned a remark into a well-received boost.

My intention

Before giving feedback: what's your real caring intention?

Person ≠ act

Reframe a note to target the act/behavior, not the person.

→ *Feedback serves growth, not judgment.*

Concrete methods

Giving: factual feedback — Situation, Behavior, Impact — in private, and ask permission ('may I give you some feedback?'). Receiving: listen without defending, clarify, sort what's useful, thank them.

A method keeps emotion from taking over.

Example

Using Situation-Behavior-Impact, Sofia gave hard feedback without hardening her colleague.

My feedback (S-B-I)

Prepare feedback: Situation · observed Behavior · Impact · request/wish.

Receiving well

For a recent criticism: what was useful to keep? What was just the delivery?

→ *Factual to give, sorting to receive — it can be methodical.*

Practical tips & advice

Tips & advice

- Give factual feedback: Situation + Behavior + Impact (no judgment of the person).
- In private, when calm, and ask permission ('may I give you some feedback?').
- Balance what's going well and what's to improve.
- To receive: listen without defending, clarify, then sort.
- Keep what's useful, drop the clumsy delivery, say thanks.
- A point to improve says nothing about your overall worth.

To fill in

My feedback (S-B-I)

Situation	Behavior	Impact / request

Criticism received

What's useful to me	What was just delivery

PLAN

Your 4-week plan

Week 1 — Understand what feedback stirs up.

Week 2 — Soften all-or-nothing thoughts.

Week 3 — Give with a clear intention.

Week 4 — Methods to give & receive.

Your plan in 3 lines

- The feedback I want to give (S-B-I):
- What I keep from a criticism received:
- My line to ask permission:

TO CLOSE

Factual and caring — feedback grows people.

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This guide is a coaching and psychoeducation tool, not a substitute for therapy. If you are going through a hard time, please reach out to a professional or a crisis line in your country. © PerfectMatch · EvaTalk.